Seasons & water

A cycle of seasons; a scale of water temperature

Seasons & water

春天	夏天	秋天	冬天
chūntiān	xiàtiān	qiūtiān	dōngtiān
spring	summer	autumn / fall	winter
温暖 wēnnuǎn — warm / mild	炎热 yánrè — very hot	凉爽 liángshuǎng — pleasantly cool	寒冷 hánlěng — cold / chilly

Water temperature · examples from the board

0°C	20–30°C	40–60°C	80–100°C
冰水	常温水	温水	热水
bīngshuǐ	chángwēnshuǐ	wēnshuǐ	rèshuǐ
ice water	room-temperature water	warm water	hot water

Approximate classroom labels, NOT drinking-temperature advice. Hot water can burn.

春天很温暖。

Chūntiān hěn wēnnuǎn.

Spring is warm.

你的家乡冷吗？

Nǐ de jiāxiāng lěng ma?

Is your hometown cold?

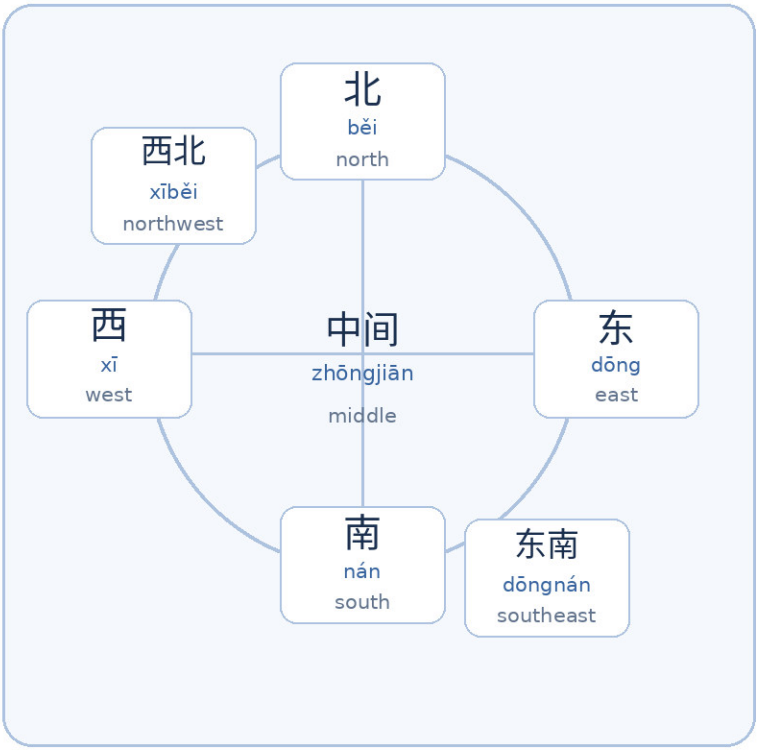
Remember

天 (tiān) means day or sky. Seasons pair 春 / 夏 / 秋 / 冬 with 天 to make complete words.

Directions & choices

Use a compass for space; use 还是 to ask “A or B?”

Compass · directions



Place words

北边	běibiān
north side	
南边	nánbiān
south side	
东边	dōngbiān
east side	
西边	xībiān
west side	
里面	lǐmiàn
inside	
外面	wàimiàn
outside	
租房	zūfáng
rent a home	

Ask a choice question

In a question, 还是 connects alternatives. Often: A 还是 B?

你喝咖啡还是茶？

Nǐ hē kāfēi háishi chá?

Do you drink coffee or tea?

你住在学校里面还是学校外面？

Nǐ zhù zài xuéxiào lǐmiàn háishi xuéxiào wàimiàn?

Do you live inside or outside the school?

你想要温水还是冰水？

Nǐ xiǎng yào wēnshuǐ háishi bīngshuǐ?

Would you like warm water or ice water?

Amounts & classifiers

Learn the complete phrase first; then inspect its parts

一点儿	一些	有点儿	很多
yìdiǎnr	yìxiē	yǒudiǎnr	hěnduō
Small quantity	Some / several	A little (feeling)	A lot
一点儿水 yìdiǎnr shuǐ a little water	一些钱 yìxiē qián some money	有点儿累 yǒudiǎnr lèi a bit tired	很多学生 hěnduō xuésheng many students

With nouns

一点儿 + N / 一些 + N

Before an adjective

有点儿 + adjective

你能给我一点儿水吗？

Nǐ néng gěi wǒ yìdiǎnr shuǐ ma?

Could you give me a little water?

你今天看起来有点儿累。

Nǐ jīntiān kàn qǐlái yǒudiǎnr lèi.

You look a little tired today.

Measure words · noun classifiers

一把钥匙	一本书	两辆汽车
yì bǎ yàoshi	yì běn shū	liǎng liàng qìchē
one key	one book	two cars

Number + measure word + noun. Use 两 (liǎng) before many classifiers for “two”.

How difficult is it?

Contrast degree words instead of memorising six unrelated sentences

01

不难

bù nán

not difficult

02

不太难

bú tài nán

not too difficult

03

有点儿难

yǒudiǎnr nán

a little difficult

04

很难

hěn nán

difficult / very difficult

05

太难了

tài nán le

too difficult!

06

难极了

nán jí le

extremely difficult

有点儿 often suggests a mild problem; 很 may simply link a subject and adjective. 太⋯了 depends on context.

Contrast with 但是 (dànshì) · but

汉语有点儿难。

Hànyǔ yǒudiǎnr nán.

Chinese is a little difficult.

汉语不太难，但是很有意思。

Hànyǔ bú tài nán, dànshì hěn yǒu yìsi.

Chinese is not too difficult, but it is very interesting.

我今天有点儿困。

Wǒ jīntiān yǒudiǎnr kùn.

I am a little sleepy today.

Everyday classroom Chinese

Groups that share meaning or graphic components

Polite phrases

请问	qǐngwèn	excuse me / may I ask
请讲	qǐngjiǎng	please speak / go ahead

Actions

起立	qǐlì	stand up
起床	qǐchuáng	get out of bed
醒了	xǐng le	woke up
切	qiē	cut

Classroom & life

湿巾	shījīn	wet wipe
抽纸	chōuzhǐ	paper tissues
够了	gòu le	enough / that is enough
冰淇淋	bīngqílín	ice cream

Recognise common components



冰 · 冷 · 凉

bīng · lěng · liáng

ice / cold / cool



温 · 湿

wēn · shī

warm / wet



请 · 讲 · 语

qǐng · jiǎng · yǔ

please / speak / language

Shared components are visual memory clues. Learn and write the complete expressions.

Hanzi writing

Whole words first. Trace the pale model, then write from memory.

春天 chūntiān spring

TRACE 

WRITE

夏天 xiàtiān summer

TRACE 

WRITE

秋天 qiūtiān autumn / fall

TRACE 

WRITE

冬天 dōngtiān winter

TRACE 

WRITE

温水 wēnshuǐ warm water

TRACE 

WRITE

冰水 bīngshuǐ ice water

TRACE 

WRITE

Hanzi writing

Whole words first. Trace the pale model, then write from memory.

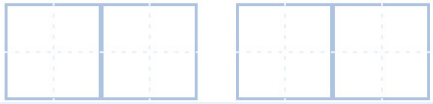
请问

qǐngwèn — excuse me / may I ask

TRACE



WRITE



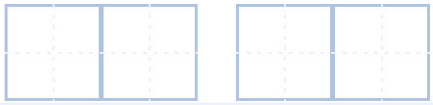
起床

qǐchuáng — get out of bed

TRACE



WRITE



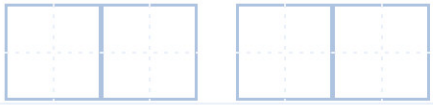
还是

háishi — or (in questions)

TRACE



WRITE



一点儿

yìdiǎnr — a little (quantity)

TRACE



WRITE



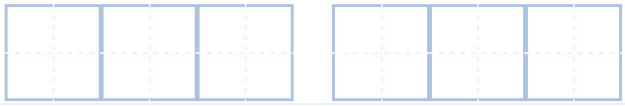
有点儿

yǒudiǎnr — a bit / somewhat

TRACE



WRITE



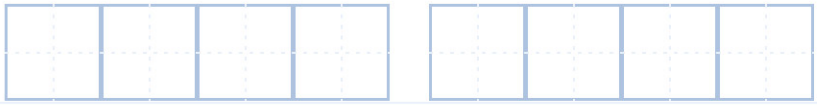
很有意思

hěn yǒu yìsi — very interesting

TRACE



WRITE



Write full sentences

Read the meaning, trace once, then write the complete sentence.

你的家乡冷吗？

Nǐ de jiāxiāng lěng ma?

Is your hometown cold?

TRACE

你 的 家 乡 冷 吗

WRITE

你喝咖啡还是茶？

Nǐ hē kāfēi háishi chá?

Do you drink coffee or tea?

TRACE

你 喝 咖 啡 还 是 茶

WRITE

你能给我一点儿水吗？

Nǐ néng gěi wǒ yìdiǎnr shuǐ ma?

Could you give me a little water?

TRACE

你 能 给 我 一 点 儿 水 吗

WRITE

Write full sentences

Read the meaning, trace once, then write the complete sentence.

汉语有点儿难。

Hànyǔ yǒudiǎnr nán.

Chinese is a little difficult.

TRACE

汉 语 有 点 儿 难

WRITE

你今天看起来有点儿累。

Nǐ jīntiān kàn qǐlái yǒudiǎnr lèi.

You look a little tired today.

TRACE

你 今 天 看 起 来 有 点 儿 累

WRITE

汉语不太难，但是很有意思。

Hànyǔ bú tài nán, dànshì hěn yǒu yìsi.

Chinese is not too difficult, but it is very interesting.

TRACE

汉 语 不 太 难 但 是 很 有 意 思

WRITE

Read without pinyin

Read aloud first. Then cover the text and recall its meaning.

01
请问，温水在哪里？

02
春天很温暖。

03
冬天很冷。

04
你的家乡冷吗？

05
你喝咖啡还是茶？

06
你能给我一点儿水吗？

07
汉语有点儿难。

08
汉语不太难，但是很有意思。

09
你今天看起来有点儿累。

10
我起床了。

11
一本书。

12
两辆汽车。

Check yourself

1. Explain 还是 with a choice question.
2. How is 一点儿 different from 有点儿?
3. Name all four seasons in Chinese.

Pocket reference · 1

Words from the blackboard, grouped for fast review

Seasons / weather

春天	chūntiān spring
夏天	xiàtiān summer
秋天	qiūtiān autumn / fall
冬天	dōngtiān winter
温暖	wēnnuǎn warm / mild
炎热	yánrè very hot
凉爽	liángshuǎng pleasantly cool
寒冷	hánlěng cold / chilly

Water

冰水	bīngshuǐ ice water
常温水	chángwēnshuǐ room-temperature water
温水	wēnshuǐ warm water
热水	rèshuǐ hot water
湿巾	shījīn wet wipe
抽纸	chōuzhǐ paper tissues

Directions

还是	háishi or (in questions)
里面	lǐmiàn inside
外面	wàimiàn outside
中间	zhōngjiān middle / centre
北边	běibiān north side
南边	nánbiān south side
东边	dōngbiān east side
西边	xībiān west side
租房	zūfáng rent a home

Everyday

请问	qǐngwèn excuse me / may I ask
请讲	qǐngjiǎng please speak / go ahead
起立	qǐlì stand up
起床	qǐchuáng get out of bed
醒了	xǐng le woke up
够了	gòu le enough / that is enough
切	qiē cut
家乡	jiāxiāng hometown
冰淇淋	bīngqílín ice cream

Pocket reference · 2

Words from the blackboard, grouped for fast review

Amount / classifiers

一点儿	yìdiǎnr a little (quantity)
一些	yìxiē some / a few
有点儿	yǒudiǎnr a bit / somewhat
很多	hěnduō many / much
给	gěi give / to
能	néng be able to / can
一把钥匙	yì bǎ yàoshi one key
一本书	yì běn shū one book
两辆汽车	liǎng liàng qìchē two cars

Opinions

不难	bù nán not difficult
不太难	bú tài nán not too difficult
有点儿难	yǒudiǎnr nán a little difficult
很难	hěn nán difficult / very difficult
太难了	tài nán le too difficult!
难极了	nán jí le extremely difficult

Opinions

非常难	fēicháng nán extremely difficult
很有意思	hěn yǒu yìsi very interesting
但是	dànshì but / however
看起来	kàn qǐlái look / seem
累	lèi tired
困	kùn sleepy

Start a conversation

From the class video · introduce yourself and choose who starts

Useful lines from the story

请介绍一下你自己。

Qǐng jièshào yíxià nǐ zìjǐ.

Please introduce yourself briefly.

听起来太好了。那么谁先开始？

Tīng qǐlái tài hǎo le. Nàme shéi xiān kāishǐ?

That sounds great. So who will start?

你还是我？

Nǐ háishi wǒ?

You or me?

要不你先开始吧，小明？

Yàobu nǐ xiān kāishǐ ba, Xiǎomíng?

How about you start first, Xiaoming?

还是 (háishi) offers alternatives in questions. 要不 (yàobu) suggests a plan; 先 (xiān) means first.

Learn the whole expressions

介绍	自己	先	开始	要不
jièshào	zìjǐ	xiān	kāishǐ	yàobu
introduce	oneself	first	begin / start	how about...

Write the complete phrase

介绍自己

jièshào zìjǐ

介 绍 自 己